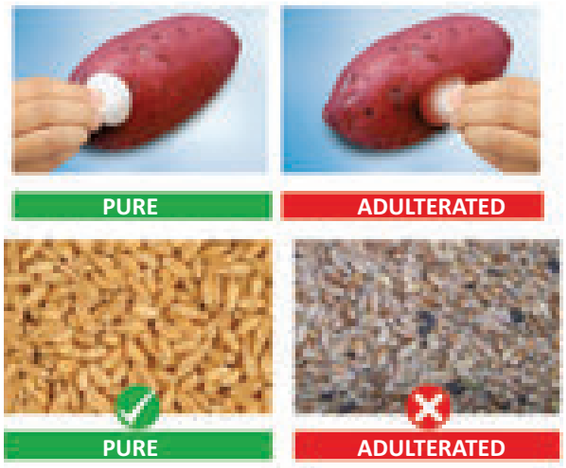
a contaminated state, the product is said to be adulterated.




The products in the market which are subject to adulteration are food, building materials, textiles, stationery etc. The products which harm consumers the most are those which are ingested.

## iii) Imitation manufacture

Markets are flooded with all kinds of spurious and substandard goods, some of them often carrying popular brand names or similar sounding brand names of popular manufacturers. Imitating these names is a deliberate malpractice and amounts to cheating of the consumers. Such products are generally of cheap quality and unsafe to use , but are sold as genuine, safe and expensive products. Such practices are commonly prevalent with the consumer goods such as shoes, soaps, tooth pastes, medicines, cosmetics, etc.




## iv) Unfair warranties

Consumers are neither familiar with nor understand the full implications of terms like guarantee and warranty. Even some of the terms of the warranty are confusing, ambiguous and are favorable to the manufacturers. There are no regulations to govern these warranties.




**Guarantee**- repairing of defective goods or/and change the defective parts free of cost for a fixed period.

**Warranty**- provides free spare parts but service charges are collected from the customer.

## v) Sales Gimmicks:

**Sales gimmicks are tricks used on consumers intended to attract attention, publicity or trade.**

Many manufacturers spend a lot of money on sales promotion through large scale advertising, free gifts, discount sales etc. Though these are projected as extra benefits to the consumers, generally the cost is hidden. It is passed on to the consumers without them becoming aware



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